

# The AM & Core Route Map

Every Goldman London route that fits your brief — asset management and the support functions — ranked by competitiveness and by how well your actual CV fits

Brief taken as: stay on the asset management side, open to operational/support roles, priority is getting into the firm, not interested in investment banking or markets trading. Roles verified live 17 Aug 2026. Labels: OFFICIAL CORROBORATED BEST GUESS

TRANSCRIPT

**Two things before the map.** First, I previously recommended FICC & Equities Sales & Trading — **withdraw that**. If you don't want the trading floor, a spring-week connection is not a good enough reason to spend a slot there; misaligned applications are a named rejection cause and you'd be selling something you don't want.

Second, and more useful: **you attended an entire day of prime services and operations sessions** — client service, execution middle office, corporate actions, synthetics, securities lending. You have first-hand, named material for the operational side of this firm that almost no applicant to those roles will have. You are not "settling" if you apply there. You are applying with an edge you already earned.

## 1. Where everything actually sits — and the vocabulary that matters

**REVENUE DIVISIONS — the businesses that earn the fees**

**Global Banking & Markets**  
(advisory, financing, trading) — you've ruled this out ·

**Asset & Wealth Management**  
(managing \$3.6tn for institutions and wealthy families) — your target

**"THE CORE" — the control and support functions**

OFFICIAL term

Risk · Controllers · Compliance · Corporate Treasury · Human Capital Management — plus Operations, Internal Audit, Legal and Regulatory Relations alongside them. These serve **every** revenue division, asset management included.

**ENGINEERING**

Builders and quants embedded across all of the above.

**Say "the Core" or "the Federation", not "back office".** Goldman's own posting for The Core Quantitative Strats defines The Core explicitly as "*Risk... Controllers... Compliance... Corporate Treasury... and Human Capital Management*" OFFICIAL. Internally these divisions are the Federation or the Core — "back office" is outsider language and carries a whiff of second-tier that Goldman deliberately avoids. Using the firm's own word in an interview is a free signal that you've done more than skim a careers page.

**How the Core connects to asset management — the bit that makes these roles interesting**

Every mandate GSAM wins creates work across the Core, and you have seen this personally: **Operations** settles the trades and services the assets; **Controllers** values the portfolios and produces the reporting clients receive; **Risk** monitors exposures; **Compliance** polices the mandate's rules and the information barriers. When BAE handed over £23bn, the client-facing win was the headline — but the deliverable was built by these teams.

INFERRED, but structurally how any manager works

## 2. Every route that fits your brief

### Inside Asset & Wealth Management

| Role (req) | Where it sits | What you'd do, and the honest read |
|------------|---------------|------------------------------------|
|------------|---------------|------------------------------------|

|                                                           |                           |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
|-----------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>AM Client Solutions Group</b><br>(171037)              | AWM — client coverage     | <b>Your primary.</b> Winning, onboarding and keeping institutional mandates. Closest thing to your Pictet work that exists at Goldman.                                                                                                                           |
| <b>AM Change Management</b><br>(171031)                   | AWM — business management | Running the projects that change how the asset manager operates: system migrations, process redesign, regulatory delivery. <b>Your DDQ portal is literally this work.</b> Small intake, thin applicant pool, and it sits <i>inside</i> AM rather than beside it. |
| <b>WM Private Wealth Management</b> (170879)              | AWM — wealth              | Advising ultra-high-net-worth families. Client-facing and stays in AWM, but the clients are individuals where all your evidence is institutional. Also a one-year placement variant (171235).                                                                    |
| <b>WM Product Management &amp; Design</b> (170935)        | AWM — platform            | Building the wealth platform's products. Your Box year is a genuine fit; less so your finance material.                                                                                                                                                          |
| <i>AM Public / Private Investing</i><br>(173051 / 173050) | AWM — investing           | <i>Listed for completeness.</i> These are the fund-manager seats: most competitive in AWM, and you've said you want the client side rather than picking securities.                                                                                              |

## The Core — support functions serving AM among others

| Role (req)                                                                                        | Serves               | What you'd do, and the honest read                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Operations</b> (170158)                                                                        | Whole firm incl. AWM | <b>Your strongest evidence match anywhere at Goldman.</b> Trade lifecycle, settlement, asset servicing, client onboarding, fixing what breaks. Your Pictet market openings, custodian coordination and trade-ready work <i>is</i> this job; your prime services day was a tour of it. |
| <b>Controllers</b> (170163)                                                                       | Whole firm           | The firm's own accountants: valuation, financial and regulatory reporting, capital. <b>Your NAV validation and performance reporting bullets land here</b> , and your bookkeeping stint supports it. Also a one-year placement (170142).                                              |
| <b>Compliance</b> (170152)                                                                        | Whole firm           | Keeping the firm inside its rules: surveillance, advisory, regulatory response. <b>Your GMRA/ISDA review is a real hook</b> — few students have read a master agreement.                                                                                                              |
| <b>Risk</b> (172894)                                                                              | Whole firm           | Measuring and managing market, credit and operational risk. Increasingly quantitative; your economics degree and 81% fit, but your evidence thread is thinner than for the three above.                                                                                               |
| <b>Internal Audit</b> (181882)<br><span>newly posted</span>                                       | Whole firm           | Independently testing whether the firm's controls actually work — unusually broad exposure to every division for a junior. <b>Only appeared on the board this week</b> , so the applicant pool is currently the thinnest on this page. Also a one-year placement (181881).            |
| <b>Office of Regulatory Relations</b><br>(170160)                                                 | Whole firm           | Managing regulator relationships and examinations. Tiny, niche, genuinely low volume — but a narrow specialism to commit to at 21.                                                                                                                                                    |
| <b>Human Capital Management</b><br>(170145) · <b>Corporate &amp; Workplace Solutions</b> (170173) | Whole firm           | People function; and the firm's own real estate, workplace and procurement. Legitimate routes in, but furthest from your evidence and your interests.                                                                                                                                 |

**One borderline case: Transaction Banking, Coverage (162040).** It sits in Global Banking & Markets, so on a strict reading it's outside your brief — but it is *not* trading and not deal advisory. It's corporate treasury services (payments, FX, liquidity) with a client-coverage seat, and the posting describes it as a tech-forward platform business. Your Box year plus Pictet client servicing fit it well and the pool is thin. Mentioning it because ruling it out on the GBM label alone would be a mistake — but it is your call.

## 3. Competitiveness — honest ranking BEST GUESS

Goldman publishes no per-role application counts. This is informed judgement from applicant behaviour, intake sizes and how heavily each role is marketed — directionally reliable, not precise. Firmwide intern acceptance has been under 1% for three straight years, so "less

competitive" is relative, never easy.

|           |                                                                                                                                            |
|-----------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| BRUTAL    | IB Classic · FICC & Equities S&T · AM Private Investing · AM Public Investing — <i>all outside your brief anyway</i>                       |
| VERY HIGH | IB Capital Solutions · <b>AM Client Solutions Group</b> — the client-facing AM seat is well known and well applied to                      |
| HIGH      | <b>WM Private Wealth Management</b> · Risk · Engineering (separate pool)                                                                   |
| MODERATE  | <b>Operations</b> · <b>Controllers</b> · <b>Compliance</b> · TxB Coverage · WM Product Management                                          |
| THINNEST  | <b>Internal Audit</b> (just posted) · <b>AM Change Management</b> · Office of Regulatory Relations · HCM · Corporate & Workplace Solutions |

## 4. Fit against YOUR CV, scored

Scoring what a screener would see in five seconds: does this person's history point at this desk? **My judgement**

| Role                 | CV fit                                                                                  | The specific evidence that carries it                                                                                                                                                                                               |
|----------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Operations           |  9.5   | 50 segregated market openings, custodian coordination, trade-ready status, NAV/performance validation, GMRA/ISDA, a portal automating a manual tracker — plus a full prime services insight day. Nothing on your CV is wasted here. |
| AM Client Solutions  |  9.0   | Client servicing and onboarding at an asset manager, institutional clients, DDQs, performance reporting. Perfect fit, higher competition.                                                                                           |
| AM Change Management |  8.5  | The DDQ portal replacing a 400-line tracker across 20 teams is a change-management case study; the Box 60-day onboarding plan is a second one.                                                                                      |
| Controllers          |  7.5 | NAV, excess return versus benchmark, inception-to-date validation; bookkeeping experience; economics at 81%.                                                                                                                        |
| Compliance           |  7.0 | GMRA and ISDA review, eligible collateral and margin thresholds, resolving queries without escalating to legal.                                                                                                                     |
| WM Private Wealth    |  6.5 | Client-facing instinct and AWM familiarity — but institutional evidence for an individual-client desk.                                                                                                                              |
| Internal Audit       |  6.0 | Process and controls exposure, documentation review, an economics degree. Credible rather than compelling — but the thinnest pool on the board.                                                                                     |
| Risk                 |  5.5 | Economics, collateral and margin exposure, analytical work. Weaker thread than the roles above.                                                                                                                                     |

## 5. The recommendation, revised to your brief

- 1. AM Client Solutions Group (171037)** — unchanged. Your best-fit, best-story application, already written.
- 2. Operations (170158)** — the one I'd add without hesitation. Best evidence match at the firm, moderate competition rather than brutal, serves asset management directly, and you have an entire insight day of named, specific material for the letter. This is a strong application, not a fallback.
- 3. AM Change Management (171031)** — keeps you inside Asset Management, thin applicant pool, and your portal build is almost a purpose-written qualification. High value per unit of competition.
- 4. Hold in reserve**, or spend on **Internal Audit (181882)** while it is freshly posted and thinly applied to, or **Controllers (170163)** if the reporting side appeals more than audit.

That portfolio is coherent: one client-facing AM seat, one operational seat serving AM, one change seat inside AM. Every one of them is defensible with the same underlying story — *I understand how a client's experience of an asset*

manager is actually delivered, and I want to build that at scale — which means three strong applications rather than one strong and two hopeful.

## 6. The honest answer on "get in, then move"

You said the priority is getting into Goldman. That's a legitimate strategy, and internal mobility at the firm is genuinely real — you heard the evidence yourself: Jessica has had five or six different jobs across two continents; Jack moved across derivatives, cash and sales leadership; Ahmed moved from banking into investing after eighteen months.

TRANSCRIPT

**But be clear-eyed about two things.** Moves from the Core into a revenue-generating AWM seat are harder than moves within a division or between Core teams — they happen, but they are earned over years, not months, and usually by someone who became indispensable to the business they support. And you should never say "this is my way in" out loud: an Operations interviewer is hiring someone who wants Operations, and the fastest way to lose the offer is to signal you want somewhere else. **Apply to roles you would genuinely be happy to do** — which, given your Pictet summer, Operations honestly is.

## 7. The advantage you're holding and may not have noticed

Your insight events covered a full day of **prime services and operations**: client services with Shash and Louis, execution middle office with James O'Connell's team, corporate actions and asset servicing, synthetics and swaps middle office, securities lending, custom baskets, digital assets and tokenisation.

That gives you, for an Operations application, exactly the un-fakeable asset you have for CSG: **a genuine interaction, named people, and specific technical detail no careers page contains** — T+1 matching and CTM, why Belgian rights issues are the classic late-trading trap, how a special can cost 7–8% versus 30–35bps of general collateral, why the EIB blockchain bond settling in ~45 seconds matters for collateral velocity. Almost nobody applying to Operations can write a sentence like that, let alone connect it to their own market-openings work at Pictet.

You already have the material for two genuinely differentiated applications. You only thought you had one.

## 8. Next steps

1. **Resolve the eligibility question** on the requisition before spending any slot — June 2027 graduation may point you to the New Analyst Programme instead. This governs everything.
2. Fix the CV: the missing **"diligence"**, the hyphens, and rebuild the Skills section out of a table.
3. For Operations, write a genuinely separate letter: lead with the prime services day, bridge to your Pictet market openings and custodian work, close on wanting to understand the machinery at Goldman's scale. **Do not recycle the CSG letter.**
4. For Change Management, the DDQ portal is your opening paragraph — a manual quarterly tracker turned into a routed system, and what that taught you about how firms actually change.
5. Ask your friend in Client Solutions which Core teams work most closely with CSG. That answer tells you which second application genuinely compounds with your first.

**Sources.** Role list and requisition IDs: live pull from Goldman's Oracle Recruiting Cloud, 17 Aug 2026. "The Core" definition: Goldman's own Core Quantitative Strats posting text **OFFICIAL**. Division descriptions: the postings themselves. Acceptance-rate context: Fortune reporting on sub-1% intern acceptance. Panel and prime-services material: your insight-event transcript **TRANSCRIPT** — verify names before quoting.

Competitiveness rankings and CV fit scores are my labelled judgement, not Goldman data; treat them as a decision aid rather than fact. The live posting always overrides this document.